Culdaff
Fr John McDevitt P.P. 9376273 / 0858237119
Fr. Karl Haan C.C. 9379107
www.culdaffparish.com
email: culdaffnotes@gmail.com

Daily Mass
Monday 7.30 pm; **Tuesday & Wednesday**, 10 am [Blessed Sacrament Exposition after 10 am Mass until 2 pm];
Thursday, 7.30 pm;
Friday, **10 am**, Mass and Burial of Ashes of Mary Ryan (nee Doherty) Ballyharry; **Saturday** 11 am.

Confessions Before Saturday nights Mass, 7.30 – 7.50

Saturday Vigil [Feast of All Saints] 8 pm
Sunday [All Saints Day]10 am.

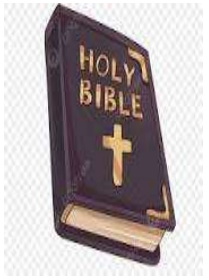
Anniversary Mass this weekend
Saturday Vigil 8 pm: Mary & Patrick Duncan, Croragh and Laura Finnegan, Kerry

Next Weekend
Saturday 8 pm James Morgan, Carndonagh [1st Anniversary]
Sunday 10 am Kathleen McDermott, Leitrim [1st Anniversary]

Weekly Offering €1,080
Mission Sunday Collection €520

Envelopes can be left in McGuinness' shop.

First Reading
Exodus 22:20-26
The Lord teaches that compassion ought to be shown to the alien and to the poor.
Second Reading
1 Thessalonians 1:5c-10
Paul tells the Thessalonians that their conversion to the Lord has been an example to all believers.
Gospel Reading
Matthew 22:34-40
The Pharisees continue to test Jesus with a question about the greatest commandment.



VOCATIONS - St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

We will have a **Memory Tree** on the Altar during the Month of November. You are invited to write the names of your departed family members, on the labels provided, and hang them on the tree. They will be remembered at each Mass in the church, culminating in our **Annual Mass for all the Dead of the Parish** on Sunday, 29th November.



Greencastle Centre - Gwyneth & Sarahs Art Camp Tues 27th Oct 10am-1pm €30 Call/Text/WhatsApp 083 462 7073.
- Memories & Mementoes Scrapbooking course 6 weeks starting Thursday 22nd October 7–9pm €30 for 6 weeks.
- FREE high-Vis vests available at reception.
- Beekeeping for Beginners 6 week course starting Saturday 7th November 11am- 1pm.

Carrowmenagh Community Centre Tel 074 93 67061
The **Sunday Night Dance** will take place this Sunday, 25th October, 8-10.30pm. Old time, ceilidh, line dancing and jiving. Admission €5.
Places available on our **creative writing, woodwork, digital skills for farmers, plumbing, Christmas wreath making, Christmas Centrepiece, Christmas lanterns, and Kid's Halloween craft** courses. Contact the centre for more information and to book.

Annual Solemn Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00pm, beginning this Sunday 25 October. ***The theme of our Novena this year is 'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'.*** Each night will comprise of the Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament. We encourage everybody, including those in particular need of healing to join us.

Culdaff FC Annual Bazaar will be held in Bocan Hall on Sunday 6th Dec. Entry is free and there will be the usual array of prizes, teas/ coffee & snacks and a visit from the man himself Santa Claus. Doors will open at 4.30pm and further updates nearer the time.

Men's Sherd -Still time to go to Thursday's class at the Men's Shed Carn. Are you nervous about going online ? This is the one for you. A FREE Course, from 11 am - 1 pm for four weeks. An IT taster course to teach you to navigate the internet, shop safely, send emails etc. Contact Denis at 074 93 62218 or email denis@inishowen.ie Runs every Thursday in October.

Whist
1st Vera Deeny
2nd Eileen Gormley
3rd Rose Thompson
Gerard Doherty

Tickets Patrick McLaughlin, Betty Doherty, Kevin Lafferty
Other Winners Patrick McLaughlin, John McLaughlin, Dolores O'Donnell, Kevin Lafferty

CULDAFF TIDY TOWNS This year's annual Culdaff Craft Fair will take place on Sunday 15 November from 2-5pm in the Wee Hall Culdaff. Afternoon teas served and a draw for valuable prizes will take place. For more information and bookings contact Philomena on 0868418189.

Spraoi agus Spórt Activities for Children and Families
Parent & Toddler Sensory Play - Tuesdays, 10am-1pm.
Mammy & Baby - Wednesdays, 10am-1pm.
Parent & Toddler Messy Play - Thursdays, 10am-1pm.
Unit 6, SuperValu, Carndonagh, F93 AY6D.
Book at spraoiagussport.ie.
Spraoi na Samhna
Spraoi na Samhna at Spraoi agus Spórt, Carndonagh, offers lots of Halloween activities including a pumpkin patch, slime-making, sewing, cupcake decorating, gaming and coding camps. Parent & Toddler sessions feature sensory play, messy play and baby groups. Events run 24th–30th October. Book at spraoiagussport.ie.
Charities Institute Ireland Awards
Spraoi agus Spórt has been shortlisted for three 2026 People's Choice Awards with Charities Institute Ireland. Finance Team of the Year, Fundraising Team of the Year, and Charity of the Year. Show your support by voting at https://bit.ly/4zbnAxX and enter a draw to win an Amazon Echo Dot.

Serenity House Linocut Card Making and Calligraphy course starting Wednesday 4th November 7pm - 9pm.
Serenity House is proud to be a drop off point for the Christmas Shoebox Appeal appeal 2026 again this year. All boxes must be in Serenity House by Monday 9th November.

Moville Celtic Christmas Market (Christmas crafts, Santa's grotto) on Saturday 5 December 1-5pm. Stalls available for €20.

Tea in Bocan Hall next Sunday, 1st November, after 10 am Mass. All welcome.

Greencastle Centre - Thanks to everyone who donated to our church gate collection last week.
- Balance With Bronagh Halloween Special Saturday 31st October 11am – 11:45am Tel: 00447827057701.
- Christmas Wreath Workshop Thursday 26th November 7pm – 9pm contact Hayley to book: 00447947431574.
- Christmas Craft Fair Saturday 21st November 12pm – 3pm tables only €20.
- Citizens Advice drop-in every Wednesday 9:30am – 4:30pm.

Remember Clocks go **back** 1 hour tonight.

CHIROPODIST CLINIC Patricia Barne will a end St Columbcille Centre, Clonmany on Wed Oct 28 from 9am-2pm. For an appointment call 0749363282.

POINTS TO PONDER –
25 October 2026
To love the Lord with all our heart – is this even possible? A common assumption is that love must just come, that it grows organically, and that it cannot be forced. That's infatuation, not true love. Any kind of love – for a parent, spouse, child, or friend – will reach a point during which it is no longer easy. For love to be true, it must be a free choice and commitment.

'All your heart, soul, and mind' sounds rather extreme, even rather dangerous. The world says that loving anyone totally is a risky proposition – what if the one we love rejects us or lets us down, leaving us with nothing? And the world is even more terrified to love God totally, who cannot even be seen.
This makes sense; after all, to love totally is to trust that we will find fulfillment precisely by not looking for it ourselves, but by looking to fulfill someone else. That old, almost clichéd phrase, 'love grows when it is given away,' is actually spot-on in this regard.

True love takes a leap of faith, which is what frightens nonbelievers. Many people are okay with going to church every now and then or volunteering for a charity from time to time (and posting it on Instagram, of course).
Loving like that does not require us to make any kind of leap, any kind of definitive change, any commitment. But loving God with everything means that all we do is for love of him. We trust that he will take care of us. That is heroic; that is what it means to be a saint

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY
'Remember that nothing is small in the eyes of God. Do all that you do with love.'
Saint Thérèse of Lisieux
'We have been called to heal wounds, to unite what has fallen apart, and to bring home those who have lost their way.' *Saint Francis of Assisi*
'I invite all Christians, everywhere, at this very moment, to a renewed personal encounter with Jesus Christ, or at least an openness to letting him encounter them; I ask all of you to do this unfailingly each day.' *Pope Francis (EG 3)*

Choir Director: St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, 10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, tel (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or email them to recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications must be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or Garda Síochána, Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or TUSLA Family & Child Agency 00353 749102233 ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108

CULMORE PARISH

Parish Newsletter

THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME • 25 OCTOBER 2026 • YEAR A

Gospel Reflection | Matthew 22:34–40

In today's Gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognise the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

Prayer for the Week • May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Sunday Readings | 1 November – All Saints

First Reading: Revelation 7:2–4, 9–14 • Psalm: 24:1–2, 3–4, 5–6
Second Reading: 1 John 3:1–3 • Gospel: Matthew 5:1–12

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday: St Otteran, monk • Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles
Thursday: St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop • Friday: St John of Capistrano, priest
Saturday: St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Prayer, Worship & Vocations

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "with the joy of the Holy Spirit" that they took to the Gospel. We pray for future priests of our diocese, that they will experience the joy of the Spirit as they read, live and preach the Good News of God's love.

Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours Tuesday 3 November and 1 December, 8–9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Priesthood? Meeting in Derry on Sunday 8 November at 4 pm. Contact Fr Pat O'Hagan, Diocesan Vocations Director: pgoh2111@gmail.com or (028) 7938 6259.

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets Wednesday 28 October, 12.30–1.30 pm, at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas at Long Tower Church, Derry, 6 pm, beginning Sunday 25 October. Theme: "Make Me a Channel of Your Peace – Celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis." Each night includes the Rosary, Novena prayers and petitions, a guest talk, Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and Benediction. All welcome, especially those in need of healing. Webcam: https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Parish & Diocesan Events

6–8 NOV	**A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett** Termonbacca, Derry. Prayer, reflection and an opportunity to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact: termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or facebook.com/TermonbaccaDerry/
15 NOV	**Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group – Golden Jubilee** Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing at Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration 9.30 am; concluding with afternoon Mass. Theme: "People of God's Delight" (Ps 149:4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. £40 including coffee and lunch. Book by 1 November: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.
19 NOV	**The Columban Young Adults – Holy Hour & Meditation** 7 pm, Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry. For ages 18–35. Meditation by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. New members welcome. Contact: columbanyoungadults@gmail.com.
20–22 NOV	**Abide Women's Conference** Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan and the Nashville Dominicans. Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin. Registration: Abide in His Love on Eventbrite.ie.
5 DEC	**St Patrick's, Dungannon – Charismatic Prayer Group Golden Jubilee** Servite Priory, Benburb, 11 am–3 pm, concluding with Mass. Theme: "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come." Everyone welcome.

Marriage & Family Life

ACCORD Derry – Marriage Preparation Courses In-person at the Everglades Hotel, Derry. Dates: 29–30 January, 19–20 February and 19–20 March 2027. Book at www.accordni.com.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend St Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo, Friday 9–Sunday 11 April 2027. Residential weekend for married couples, beginning Friday at 7.30 pm and ending Sunday at 4.30 pm. Online booking only: www.marriageencounter.ie.

Job Opportunity

Choir Director – St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry Experienced Choir Director sought for 10 hours per week to lead the cathedral choir and enhance worship through music. Application pack: (028) 7126 2302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, or by email, by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer; applications from all communities welcome.

CULMORE PARISH • Growing together in faith, hope and love.